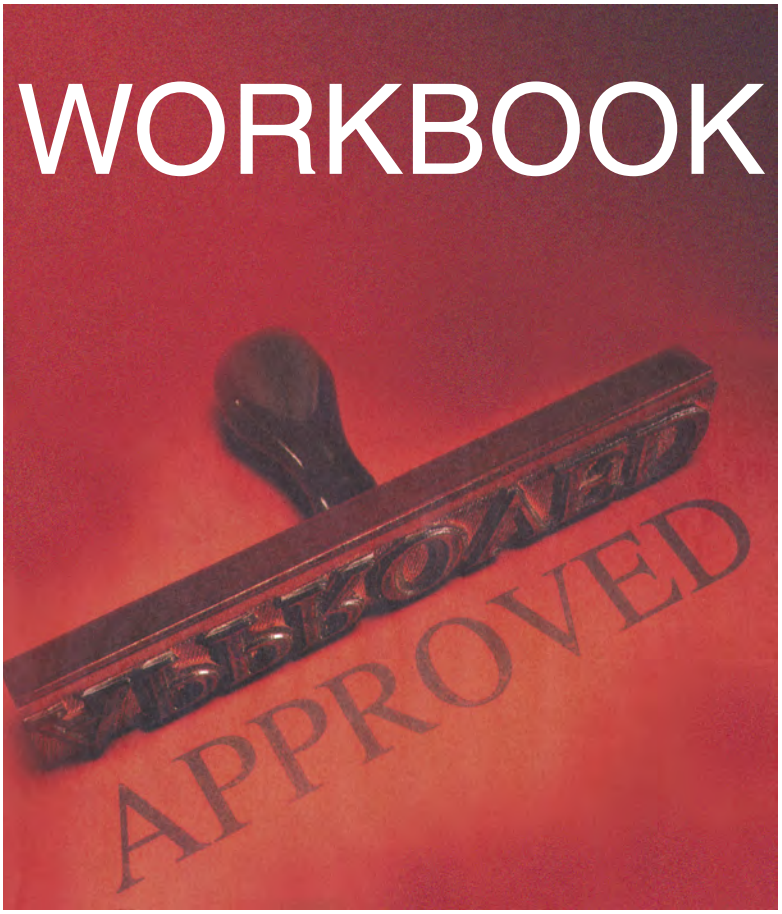
Nightingale Conant

Roger Dawson's

Confident Decision Making

How to make the right choice every time



IMPORTANT

To begin—Please save this workbook to your desktop or in another location.

Contents

Introduction.....1

Self-Test I.....2

SESSION 1:
Basics to Confident Decision Making 3

SESSION 2:
Intuitive Techniques.....9

SESSION 3:
Logical Techniques 13

SESSION 4:
Group Decision Making 25

SESSION 5:
Barriers to Good Decision Making.....29

SESSION 6:
Styles of Decision Making.....31

SESSION 7:
Characteristics of Great Decision Makers 34

Self-Test II: 35

Know Your Driving Life Force.....36

Optimist or Pessimist? 37

Notes 38

Expand Your Success Library.....Last page

Introduction

Life constantly presents you with problem/opportunity scenarios. How you turn problems into opportunities, how you take greatest advantage of these opportunities, all lies in your decision-making ability.

As we thoroughly examine in the *Confident Decision Making* audio program, this ability can be honed and improved to the extent that you can be sure that every decision you ever make will be the RIGHT decision. The RIGHT decision based upon proven techniques coupled with your own personal insight. The RIGHT decision not agonized over, but a decision wisely made to improve your life and the lives of those around you.

How important are decisions? Well, I call decisions the building blocks of life. I hope you agree that you truly are a result of your decisions. And that your future depends upon decisions that you make today and tomorrow. The goal is to positively enhance the quality of your life and the lives of those around you through making better decisions.

The technology of decision making given in my audio program unveils the secrets of the Great Decision Makers. You'll learn:

- **How your personality style affects your decision making.**
- **How to develop and use both intuition and logic.**
- **When to rely more strongly on intuition or logic for the decisions you face.**
- **How to integrate logic with the magic of intuition.**
- **The strengths and weaknesses of your decision-making style.**
- **The barriers to good decision making...and more!**

Once you put these techniques to work for you—you simply cannot fail to make the right decision each and every time! You're a Confident Decision Maker.

—Roger Dawson

Self Test I

You'll get the maximum benefit from this audio program if you'll take a few moments right now to complete this self-evaluation test. It's very important to take this *before* you listen to the tapes, or, at the very minimum, before you begin implementing the ideas you'll learn in the program.

This test repeats at the back of this workbook. We ask that you take it again *after* you have listened to the program several times and have implemented the ideas it offers in your daily decision-making processes. This will show you the progress you've made.

Instructions: For each type of decision listed below, score yourself on a scale of one to ten, with ten being the highest, as to how well you feel you are doing at making good decisions in each of these areas of your life.

Name_____ Job/Title_____	
Business decision making	
Decisions involving how to spend money	
Decisions involving personal relationships	
Decisions about career moves	
Decisions involving your children	
Investment decisions	
Decisions involving your parents	
Total score	

SESSION 1
Basics to Confident Decision Making

The best place to start Confident Decision Making is to become aware of your current techniques, or lack of techniques, in making decisions. This should help you see how developing and perfecting a technology of decision making can enhance your life.

The first basic step is to change the way you think about a decision, to shift your attention from the decision to the decision-making process. Once you develop a process that works for you, you'll be confident that you're always making the right decisions.

What Kind of Decision Maker Am I?

	Left Brain (non -emotional)	Right Brain (emotional)
Assertive	Pragmatic	Extrovert
Non-Assertive	Analytical	Amiable

In developing this process, I find it's best to define your personality style, as it determines how you make decisions. There are four main personality styles:

The Pragmatic. Wants the bottom line. Concerned only about useful information. Conscious of time management. Short attention span. More assertive. Makes decisions quickly and typically based on fact.

The Analytical. Wants all the details. Always looking for more information. Long attention span. Less assertive. Makes decisions slowly and typically based on fact.

The Amiable. Wants everyone to be comfortable, happy and enjoying oneself. Long attention span. Less assertive. Makes decisions slowly and typically based on emotion.

The Extrovert. Wants to have fun. Likes to joke, socialize and run with a fun idea. Short attention span. More assertive. Makes decisions quickly and typically based on emotion.

Table I. The Four Personality Styles

	Attention Span		Assertiveness		Decision Making		Decision Making	
	Long	Short	Less	More	Quick	Slow	Fact	Emotion
Pragmatic		X		X	X		X	
Analytical	X		X			X	X	
Amiable	X		X			X		X
Extrovert		X		X	X			X

I'm not at all suggesting that you need to change your personality, nor that you should change it. It's only important that you recognize your dominant personality style because you can then begin to overcome the inherent barriers to your own good decision making.

For instance, if you're a Pragmatic or Extrovert, you should realize that you normally jump to decisions and that you can learn steps to slow down a little. If you're Amiable or Analytical, you can discover a process that will take you right to the heart of the matter so you can avoid becoming bogged down by facts or emotional struggles.

Now, I'd like you to think about five major decisions you've made in your life, such as: your schooling or training, your vocation, career moves, marriage, where you live or relocations, investments. Pick five and as you write them down, indicate whether each one worked for you or didn't. I think it's best to choose a combination of successful and unsuccessful decisions. (Note: You may want to bookmark this page because we'll work often with your decisions throughout this book.)

Five Major Decisions I've Made

1.
2.
3.
4.
5.

Try analyzing these decisions to discover the common elements that went into each decision. It'll help you see how your personality style affected the decision or can help you start defining your personality style if you're unsure about it.

Categorizing Decisions

To be a Confident Decision Maker, you should be able to categorize decisions in terms of importance. There are five departments where all your decisions can be categorized. They are:

Parameters / Policy / Analysis / Judgment / Synthesis

Parameters Department. This is where you place your least important decisions, and the decisions that should take up the least amount of your time. You establish minimum standards for these decisions and accept the first alternative within those parameters. The most important thing to remember is that usually one choice is no better than another, so pick the first one and free yourself up for other things. Many decisions go here, and learning to make maximum use of your Parameters Department can increase your decision-making powers and free up more time.

Policy Department. This is where you place your more significant decisions. These decisions should be based upon your "mission statement" or "policy manual" and your values. Does the decision support your objective and values. Also, do you need to create a new policy or amend an old one?

Analysis Department. This department of your Decision Factory helps you analyze what might work and what definitely won't work. This is the best place to send decisions that call for a right or wrong decision.

Judgment Department. Sometimes several choices are available to you, and you must determine the best one. Decisions like this are made by the Judgment Department. This is where you use logical decision-making tools to make your choice.

Synthesis Department. When many factors must be brought together to develop a new solution, send them to this department. This is where you bring your problem when none of the solutions you've come up with seem like the right decision. Decisions coming from this department are usually quite creative and unique.

Remember those five major decisions you listed? Look back over them and try categorizing them by department.

Life consists of decisions. Here you can list decisions you made recently under the categories to which you think they belong.

Parameter Decisions	Policy Decisions	Analysis Decisions	Judgment Decisions	Synthesis Decisions

Blueprinting Decisions

Another basic step in decision making is blueprinting. This is laying out the problem completely, correctly and concisely. The mind-set to adopt at this stage is one of realism, remembering that the time for optimism is after you've made your decision.

Information is the key to accurate blueprinting. You don't want to gather information you don't need. On the other hand, you need to have enough information to make the right decisions. The secret: *knowledge is your objective in information gathering.*

You begin by developing an information-gathering system. In making major decisions, start gathering information way before you need to make the decision. The more you know, the better your intuition will be and the greater the framework you'll have in place on which to build good decisions.

Information Drifts

Beware of information drifts! They cause you to make decisions using inaccurate information and they narrow your field of opportunity. The eight types of information drifts to be aware of are:

Availability Drift: You give more weight to information that's more readily available to you. In other words, the more you're aware of something, the more you give it emphasis it doesn't deserve.

Experience Drift: You tend to see things in terms of your personal or professional interest. If you're a hockey fan, you think it's the most popular sport in the world.

Conflict Drift: Your natural tendency is to reject information that conflicts with your beliefs.

Recall Drift: You more easily recall information about things familar to you.

Selectivity Drift: Since you are unable to absorb everything, you screen out information and observations about things that do not interest you.

Anchoring Drift: If you lack expertise in a specific area, right or wrong, you latch on to or anchor to the first information you hear.

Recency Drift: You place greater emphasis on what has just happened to you. For instance, a recent traffic ticket will make you much more cautious, even if no police are in sight.

Favorability Drift: You are inclined to look harder for information that supports your beliefs rather than input that flies in the face of your preconceived notions.

To work further with information drifts, you can refer back to the five decisions you made earlier and analyze how an information drift may have been involved in each decision.

You have an additional problem when you're relying on other people as information sources—their bias. Use the following checklist to help you avoid information drift in this situation.

Checklist for Presentation of Information by Others

YES	NO	
		Does this person have a personal stake in this decision?
		Does this person have reasonable expertise in the area?
		Does this person have a prejudice in the area?
		Does this person have sufficient time to gather more than superficial information?

Obstacles To Accurate Blueprinting

- I'm too far from the problem.
- I'm too familiar with the problem.
- I'm too close to the problem.
- I'm too obsessed with the problem.
- I have misstated the problem.

SESSION 2
Intuitive Techniques

Intuition is fascinating and can be a powerful decision-making tool. We all have powers and skills of intuition that we can develop. I'm not suggesting you rely on intuition alone. The key is coupling logical decisions with the magic of intuition.

Intuition: Rapid Reasoning

Intuition can be built through concentration, patient thought, and focusing on one problem. It can actually be considered rapid reasoning. This occurs when the mind stores information in parcels rather than individual pieces by a process called "chunking." Chunking enables you to improve your access to short and long-term memory and to increase your ability to concentrate. Chunking is developed by saturating yourself with information about the decision.

Table II —The Seven Steps in Developing Reliable Intuition

1. Categorize the situation accurately so you can start looking for the solution in the right direction.

2. Blueprint the problem accurately so your mind totally focuses on the problem to solve.

3. Saturate your mind with facts about the problem.

4. Position your mind for intuitive thought by shutting down the left brain and stimulating the right.

5. Move away from the problem, either physically or mentally, so your mind can view it objectively.

6. Expand your options through a checklist of ten creative possibilities. This process is very similar to what scientists go through before they draw conclusions. With so many more answers to choose from, you'll become a more inventive decision maker.

7. Verify your intuition using the appropriate logical decision-making techniques given in Session 3.

As you probably know, the left side of the brain is the logical side and codes information verbally. The right side of your brain is the creative, intuitive side and absorbs information emotionally. The right brain works on a problem 4/10 of a second before the left brain.

Many problems in decision making are caused by the fact that the creative right brain shuts down under stress while the left brain plows through it. Since stress and decision making often go hand-in-hand, we're likely to lose our right brain input just when we need it most. The ability to control the left and right sides of the brain is the key to developing confident decision-making skills.

We're back to your personality type as we determined it in Section 1, because it will reflect whether you are a left brain or right brain decision maker.

The value of defining your personality and the type of decision making you favor is that it lets you see your strengths and weaknesses in your personal decision-making process. Having recognized these, you can take better advantage of opportunities for strengthening your weaker areas.

	STRENGTHS	WEAKNESS
Pragmatic	Decisive Logical	Overlooks Creative Solutions Not a People Person
Extrovert	Decisive Intuitively Popular	Overlooks Facts Jumps to Conclusions
Amiable	Considerate Listens to Others	Won't Make Tough Decisions Hesitant
Analytical	Gathers Facts Logical	Most Non-Decisive Paralysis of Analysis: Never Enough Information

The first three steps given in Table II help you position your mind for intuitive thought. Next, you balance the mind and allow intuition to flow in by shutting down the left brain and stimulating the right brain—letting the right brain dominate.

Shutting down the left brain shuts out mental noise—the thoughts and images from your memory, your preconceptions. It's mental noise that interferes with intuition, effectively blocking it. Inner calm produces mental clarity and right brain, intuitive thought.

It's in creative synthesis where you most often find the missing answer, the option that is there but that you've yet to find. Experts call traditional left brain thinking vertical thinking; this is where your mind builds on a series of thoughts. They call right brain thinking lateral thinking; here your mind finds creative solutions and leaps to answers.

Again, I'm going to ask you to go back to your list of five major decisions in Section 1. Choose one that was an obviously logical, left brain decision. The decision was made; there's no pressure. Following the 10 steps to Creative Synthesis in Table III, see if you can discover any better decisions.

Next, think of a logical decision you've made for the future but haven't acted upon yet. Again, the pressure is off, so you're free to release your creative powers. I feel that as good as your first decision is, you may come up with an even better decision, because there's the magic of creativity in the second one!

Use this space below.

Table III —The 10 Steps to Creative Synthesis

1. Visualize the opposite of the situation by reversing the objective or thinking contrary to conventional wisdom.
2. Examine the environment in which the problem exists, not the problem itself.
3. Visualize yourself finding the perfect answer—you are what you think.
4. Imagine that all the assumptions you've made about the decision are wrong—move away from the obvious.
5. Imagine what you'd do if you knew you couldn't fail. Utilize the "What if..." technique to grow out of your limited preconceptions.
6. Run the decision by a series of mental role models; think how they would handle it and see if you can't adopt a similar solution.
7. Think backwards—imagine the desired solution and work back to the problem. This helps you identify the missing link in the problem, what's creating the problem and what the real solution is.
8. Look at the problem from another planet—removing yourself physically or mentally from the problem.
9. Defocus on the problem and allow new opportunities and solutions to flow in.
10. Look at the problem with the innocence of a child. You should be able to cut through factual and preconceived clutter to get to the essence of a problem.

Use this space below for notes.

SESSION 3
Logical Techniques

Not all decisions can be made with intuition or with intuition alone. Logical decision-making techniques can increase your abilities to make confident decisions.

The Coin Toss

This is the simplest logical technique for decision making and is used to resolve the simplest go/no-go problems.

Often, upon a determination made by the toss, your true feelings come to the surface. For example, you may realize when the coin toss decided you should vacation in the East that you were disappointed. So you realize vacationing in the West is what you really want to do and your decision is made.

You may come to the point where you don't even have to go as far as tossing the coin. You may discover that overall you view "heads" as positive and tails as "negative" and then find yourself picking "heads" for the decisions you subconsciously support. If a pattern develops where you're pleased with "heads" outcomes and disappointed with "tails," you'll no longer need to toss the coin to decide.

Checklisting

This is another technique for simpler decision making which you can use for go/no-go problems. This checklist is made up of items – "threshold standards" – that must be on a go status to proceed. It's typical of the system a company uses to determine credit. With checklisting, go down the list to be sure each area is met. If not, it's no-go until the requirement is met or relaxed.

Quantified Evaluation

This is a more involved process in making a go/no-go decision. You make two separate lists. On one, you list factors pro your decision. On the other, list factors against the decision. Then you rate each factor on a scale of 1 to 10. (View the rating in positive terms only—10 being the most positive, 1 being the least positive.) Then you total the rates of all the factors on the "**pro**" list and divide this figure by the number of factors on the list. You repeat this procedure with your "**con**" list. Consider the list with the highest average as your best decision.

The Ben Franklin Approach

This is a more complicated technique for a go/no-go decision. First you divide a sheet of paper into two columns. You head one "Pro" and the other "Con." Then you write down factors of your decision into each column. Then you weigh them against each other. For instance, if you find one factor on each side equal, you cross out both. If you find two Pros equaling one Con, you cross out all three factors. What's left in the balance after you've weighed all factors is your decision.

PROS	CONS

Instructions: List all the Pros and Cons you can think of. Then match them up in importance. When you see a Pro that equals a Con in importance, strike out both of them. If you find two on one side that equal one on the other, strike out all three. When you see two on one side that equal three on the other, strike out all five, and so on. Whenever an additional Pro or Con occurs to you, add it to the list. The side that strikes out first loses!

1 To 10 Rating System

This technique is valuable when you have to make a more complicated decision than go/no-go; you have a choice between two possibilities—a dichotomy.

You simply rate each one, 1 being the lowest, 10 the highest, and go with the choice that you assigned the higher rating.

This technique shouldn't be used to override good, solid information, but it is useful in breaking a mental deadlock once you've narrowed your choices to two.

You can also use the 1 to 10 rating system in extracting information from others, asking them how they'd rate a specific factor or decision.

Another way to use this technique is to break up the subject into a number of factors and rate each factor. Amazingly, the rate assigned each subject as a whole and the average of each one's rated individual factors usually are the same.

The Report Card Method

This is a more complicated method for choosing between a dichotomy. You make three columns on a sheet of paper. In the first column, you list the ten things most important to you about the decision. (On a scale of 1 to 10, it's important to use 5.5 as neutral. Five as neutral skews the scale with an optimism factor.) In the second column, you rate Choice A against all ten factors and do the same with Choice B in the third column. You add up the ratings of Choice A and Choice B and go with the choice that gets the highest rating.

Use this space below for notes.

Table IV — Report Card Method
Example: Choosing Between Two Vehicles for Trip

	PATHFINDER	AEROSTAR
Gas Mileage	5	8
Availabilty of Parts	6	8
Sleeping in Vehicle	2	8
Comfort	6	8
Carrying Space	4	8
Useful After Trip	5	9
Off-Road Handling	9	7
Dependability	8	6
Price	6	8
Desire	9	5
Total	60	75

Table V — The Report Card For _____

The 10 Most Important Things aAbout This Decision	How Choice "A" Rates Regarding This Factor (Score 1-10 with 10 as most desired)	How Choice "B" Rates Regarding This Factor (Score 1-10 with 10 as most desired)
1.		
2.		
3.		
4.		
5.		
6.		
7.		
8.		
9.		
10.		
Total		

Handicapping

Handicapping is a system you can use when your decision involves multiple choices and where the outcome of each choice is predictable.

First, blueprint the objectives in positive terms. Next, on a scale of 1 to 10, weigh them according to their importance to you. List the multiple choices and rate them against each factor. Then multiply out the weighing factor by the rating number.

List alternative actions you'd take if the decision doesn't go as you'd expect.

Table VI — Handicapping
Example Illustrated: Selecting a New Job

Column A Blueprint of Location	Column B Scale of Importance to You (1-10 with 10 the Highest)	Column C Likelihood of Attaining this Objective	Column D Point Value for (Multiply Col. B Figure x Col. C Figure)	Column E Likelihood of Attaining this Objective	Column F Point Value for (Multiply Col. B Figure x Col. E Figure)
Opportunity	10	7	70 (10x7)	6	60 (10x6)
Money	8	8	64 (8x8)	7	56 (8x7)
Location	6	8	48	7	42
Benefits	6	7	42	8	48
Challenge	9	6	54	5	45
Boss	8	7	56	6	48
Position	7	8	56	8	56
Title	4	8	32	8	32
Total			422		387

This is what a completed Handicapping Chart looks like. If you were handicapping whether or not to take a job offer with Company #1 or Company #2, you can see at a glance, once you've filled in all the figures, that Company #1 is the one to join. If the third company had been involved, you would add a Col.G and Col.H to this table.

Table VII — Handicapping Chart For _____

Column A Objectives	Column B Scale of Importance to You (1-10 with 10 the Highest)	Column C Likelihood of Attaining this Objective _____	Column D Point Value for _____ (Multiply Col. B Figure x Col. C Figure)	Column E Likelihood of Attaining this Objective _____	Column F Point Value for _____ (Multiply Col. B Figure x Col. E Figure)
1.					
2.					
3.					
4.					
5.					
6.					
7.					
8.					
Total					

Note: When using this blank Handicapping Chart, remember that you need not use all the columns across. For instance, you may only have three objectives rather than the eight shown. Or you may have to add columns if there aren't enough either vertically or horizontally.

Reaction Table

This is a system used when you face a multiple choice decision and the outcome of each choice is uncertain. It works well for decisions that involve uncertainty but are "single-stage" decisions. It assumes there are three major components of any decision situation:

- Alternatives: the choices available
- Variables: the responses that could come from each alternative
- Reactions: a projection of how the other side might respond to a combination of these alternatives and variables

Table VIII — The Seven Steps to Developing a Reaction Table

1. Check to be sure the situation requires only one decision to be made at a single point in time.
2. List the alternatives available.
3. Specify all the variables that could result from these alternatives.
4. Construct a table by assigning and labeling a column for each alternative, each variable, and each possible reaction.
5. For each alternative, decide the financial reward or penalty for each possible reaction.
6. Check for and eliminate variables that would have an insignificant effect on the reaction.
7. Check for and eliminate inferior alternatives.

Table IX — The Reaction Table
Example: Companies Bidding for Project

Alternatives	Variables	Reactions
Companies Bidding	Company A Company B Company C	Bid high: $450,000 Bids your high: $400,000 Bid low: $300,000 Bid: $350,000 with 3 seniors or $330.000 with 2 seniors
If this is the place you'll bid	$400,000 $350,000 $300,000	This is your estimated chance of winning job 30% 50% 65%
# of programmers	4 at a cost of $160,000 3 at a cost of $140,000 2 at a cost of $120,000	Profits against 3 bid levels $240,000; 190,000,140,000 $260,000; 210,000,160,000 $280,000; 230,000,180,000

Table X — The Reaction Table

Alternative	%	Variable	%	Result

Determination Trees

You can use this system when you face multiple choices and where the outcome of each choice is uncertain. This is where you need to make "multi-stage" decisions. A most obvious example of this type of decision making is a military invasion. Since you don't know how the enemy will react, you must plan for every eventuality.

Since our minds can only juggle seven alternatives at once before bogging down or overloading, we need to deal with more than seven alternatives by breaking them down into components of less than seven alternatives. That's how a Determination Tree works.

A Determination Tree looks like a family tree, with branches fanning out into larger and larger numbers of boxes. In developing the Determination Tree, you place a circle between each generation where you write the possibility of each event happening as a percentage—this helps you in determining possibilities much like oddsmakers do.

On the next page, you'll find a diagram for a Determination Tree. Here's how you can use it.

List the options you're considering (up to three in number in the three large boxes that run along the lefthand side of the page). In the circles that connect with those boxes, list the likelihood of the option occurring (as a percentage figure.)

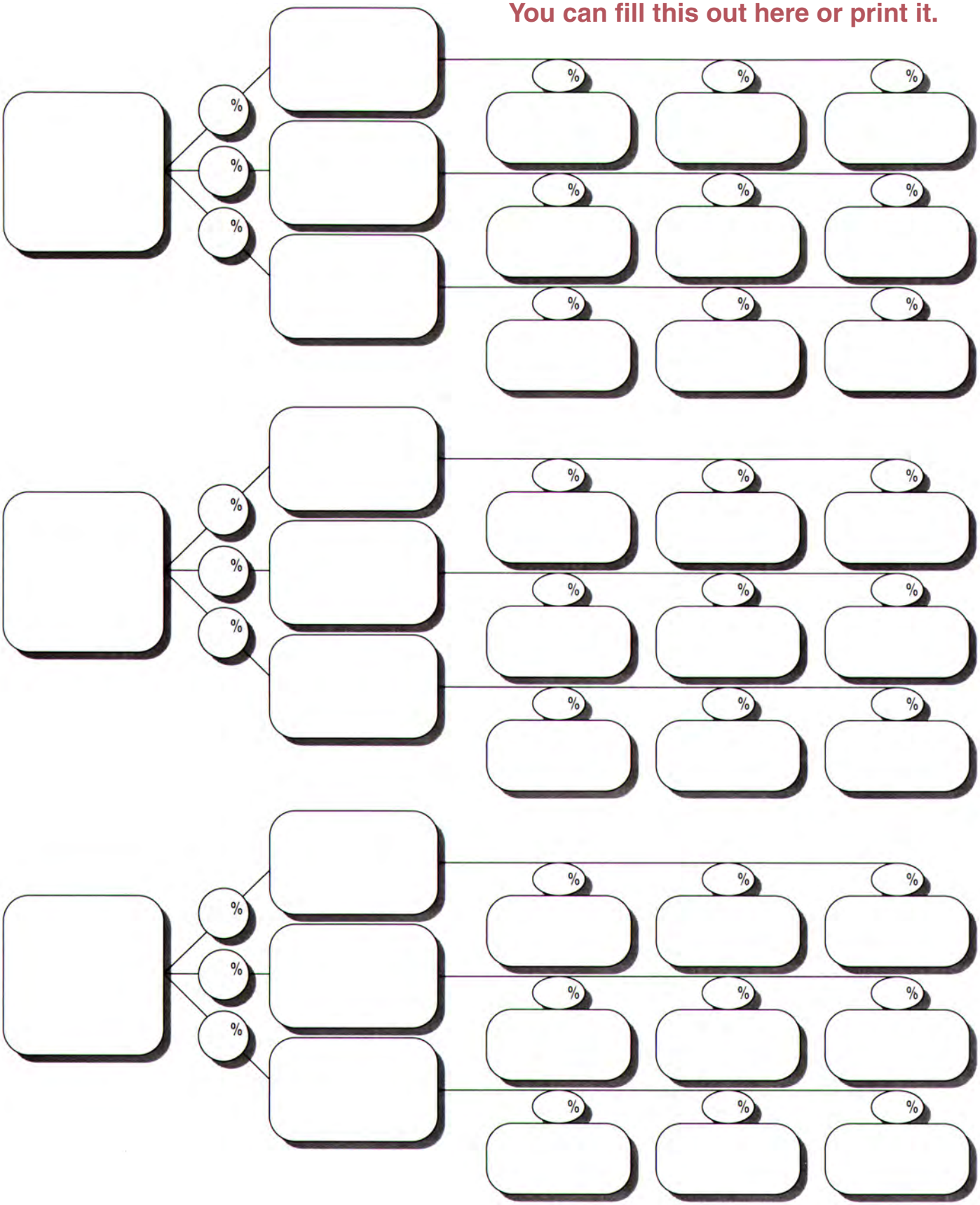
For example, in the three large boxes, you may list something like *staying put* in the first box, *moving to California* in the second box, and *joining the Marines* in the third box.

Then, for the box marked *staying put*, making this decision would entail three other decisions—(1) renting, (2) buying a home, or (3) leasing with an option to buy. These options would be listed in the three medium-size boxes. And in the circles to their left, you list the likelihood of each happening in percentages—such as 30% for the first, 60% for the second, and 40% for the third.

If the three options you've listed present other options, those should be listed in the smallest boxes shown, with the percentages of attaining them placed in the circle above them.

Should you need to consider additional steps, simply duplicate the sheet and carry the process forward to the next sheet. Complete instructions for using the Determination Tree are in the program.

Table XI — A Determination Tree
You can fill this out here or print it.



Fault Trees

This technique is the Determination Tree in reverse. You build a tree, listing the worst possible outcome of your decision. Then you work backwards and see how you arrived at the problem. Like the Determination Tree, you're breaking big problems into small portions. Determination Trees enable you to manage uncertainty while Fault Trees enable you to better anticipate problems and overcome them.

Think of a decision or two that you need to make but haven't made yet, and apply the most appropriate intuitive and logical techniques to them. Type in your answer below.

Just an interesting aside about oddsmaking: it's an effective way to get projections from employees. Simply ask them how they'd bet on the outcome of their projections. I've found it's a good technique to clarify and pinpoint.

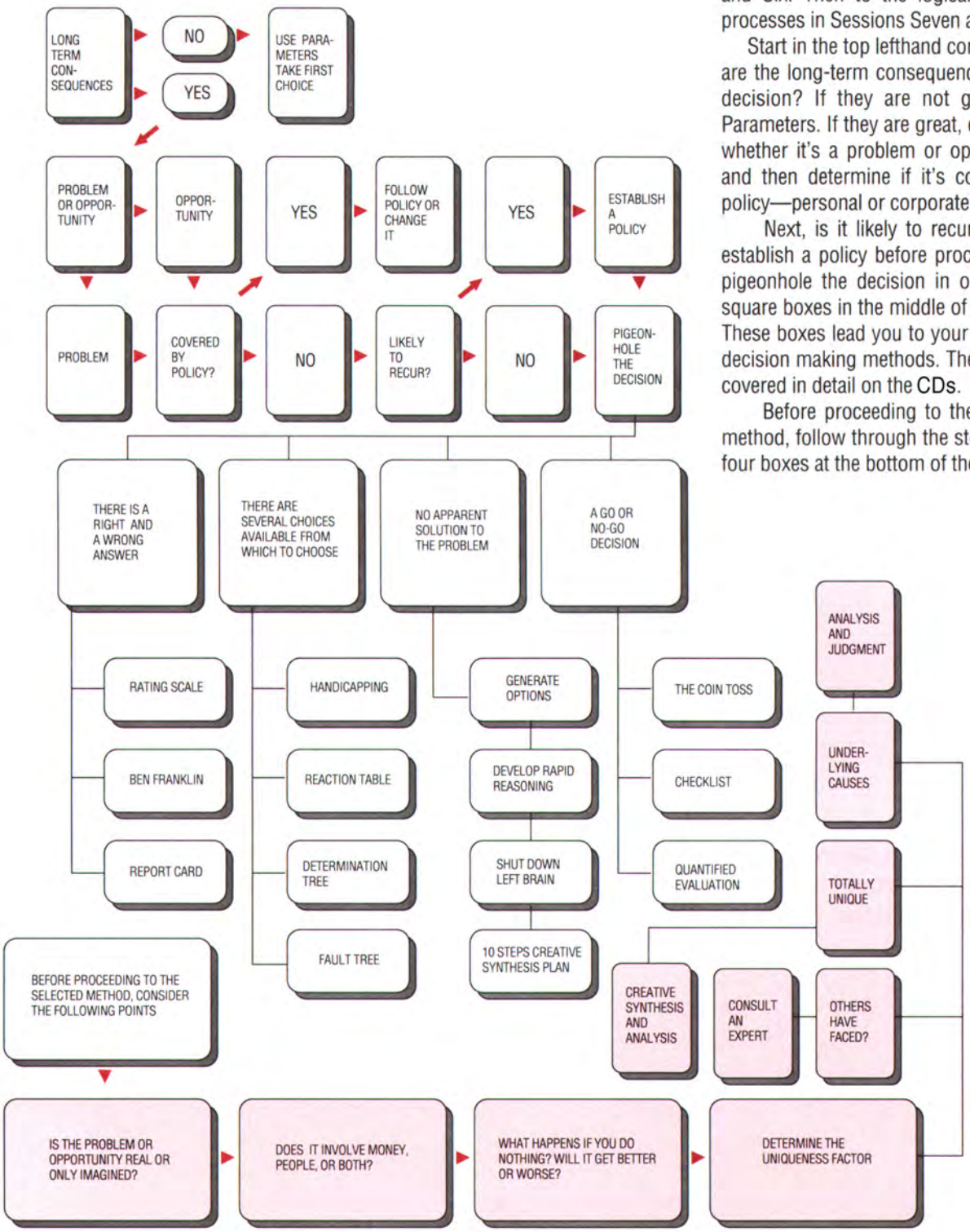
Table XII — Categorizing the Decision

This chart leads you through the Categorization Procedures in Session Two of the audio program, to the Creative Synthesis steps in Sessions Four, Five and Six. Then to the logical decision processes in Sessions Seven and Eight.

Start in the top lefthand corner: what are the long-term consequences of the decision? If they are not great, use Parameters. If they are great, determine whether it's a problem or opportunity, and then determine if it's covered by policy—personal or corporate.

Next, is it likely to recur? If it is, establish a policy before proceeding to pigeonhole the decision in one of the square boxes in the middle of the chart. These boxes lead you to your choice of decision making methods. These are all covered in detail on the CDs.

Before proceeding to the selected method, follow through the steps in the four boxes at the bottom of the page.



SESSION 4
Group Decision Making

Taking a decision or problem to a group is termed Huddling.

The Advantage Of Huddling

- Huddles outperform individuals, because the members catch each other's mistakes
- Huddling forces action on problems
- It creates a climate of involvement and trust, leading to satisfaction, motivation and morale
- Huddles reject erroneous information so your information is of better quality
- You have more people giving input which gives you more information
- The information tends to be more thorough, summations more clear
- People will support decisions they had a part in determining
- It forces you to sell your solution to others and can prevent mistakes

When To Huddle

- When you need to generate more options
- When you need outside expertise
- When you need to raise the ethical standards of the decision
- When the people making up the Huddles are the ones that are to carry out the decision
- When you're afraid the Huddle will turn down your decision

Use this space below for notes.

Methods Of Huddling

- **Formal and Semi-Formal Huddles**
  - Committee meetings, executive meetings, board meetings, brainstorming groups, etc.
- **Solo Huddling**
  - Give yourself two separate "think tank" sessions. Write down the possibilities and walk away from your list. Give your subconscious mind a chance to work over the problem. Then, at a later point in time, write down new possibilities.
  - Next, separate your list into an A list and a B list. Put anything that might work on your A list. Put things you know won't work on your B list. Rate the ideas on your A list 1 to 10. Pair the best three ideas on your A list with all the other ideas. Take the best idea on your B list and pair it with all the other ideas.
- **Analogy Huddle (Small, Qualified Group)**
  - Present a detailed statement of the problem to the group which you've developed by categorizing and blueprinting.
  - Overload the Huddle with information to reveal hidden aspects of the problem.
  - Have every member of the group state the problem in his or her words.
  - Develop analogies. They make the familiar seem strange and we see the problem in a different way.

  An example analogy is: "As bald as a billiard ball." Four types of analogies were mentioned. Try developing one or two of each type.

Use this space below for notes.

Direct	Personal	Fantasy	Symbolic

- **Computer Huddling (Computer Surveys)**
  - In the exploration stage, you ask participants to contribute information to the survey
  - In the interpretation stage, data processing experts determine how the participants view the problem
  - In the reconciliation stage, the head office team eliminates the more extreme responses and finds areas of agreement among the moderate supporters
  - In the evaluation stage, you analyze all the information and determine options for a management decision
  - In the feedback stage, you give the participants a summary of your findings

Determining Size And Content Of A Huddle

One advantage of a larger Huddle is that you increase the amount of information and this usually creates more options for you. And, you'll get more synergistic creativity.

One disadvantage of a larger Huddle is that it can cause difficulty in reaching agreements. Also, participation by less assertive members usually drops. Huddles of more than eight people tend to generate factions, where the participants separate into groups, which can be counterproductive.

A good way to determine the size of the Huddle is by first determining the type of decision you face. Small Huddles are best for concrete decisions. Larger Huddles are best for abstract opportunities. You can use a larger Huddle to debate a problem and then appoint a smaller subcommittee to develop a list of options.

Huddles also tend to work best when participants are of similar status. For instance, if you mix in trainees with vice presidents, you bring other dimensions to the table.

Disadvantages Of Huddling

- Huddling is time consuming
- A Huddle decision isn't necessarily better than a solo decision; consider the average qualifications of the group
- Members tend to rally around the opinions of the leader, especially when the leader is also the boss
- Board of directors' Huddles tend to rubber stamp decisions, particularly when the directors are overly swayed by the C.E.O.
- Board Huddles can be self-serving
- It's hard to remove a rebel member of the Huddle
- Huddles tend to compromise
- Huddles tend to spend too much time worrying over the problem and not enough time on the solutions
- Huddlers tend to become too cohesive

Signs of cohesive patterns developing:

- They don't want to consult with outside experts
- They feel they should appear united
- They don't challenge weak assertions of a member
- They don't want to be challenged from the outside

How to protect from cohesive patterns:

- The leader of the Huddle shouldn't reveal his or her decision upfront, because everyone tends to rally around it
- Don't let the Huddle become a top secret matter because it makes the Huddle coagulate
- Appoint a new devil's advocate to each of your Huddles
- Have each Huddler present two different viewpoints on the decision
- Encourage the Huddle members to call each other after the meeting, where doubts can be more freely expressed
- Have a PR person present, to tell you how this will "play in Peoria"
- Be sure the Huddle presents all acceptable alternatives and not just the one they chose
- Rotate new members into the Huddle so it doesn't turn into a clique

SESSION 5
Barriers to Good Decision Making

The Three Barriers to Good Decision Making

1. Acting too quickly
2. Acting too slowly
3. Being too autocratic

1. Don't act too quickly; instead:

- Seek additional information
- Eliminate or ignore time constraints being forced upon you by others
- Refuse to pressure yourself as well and make a decision only when you're calm and relaxed
- If you feel you're angry, depressed, tired or ill, postpone the decision until you're feeling better
- Hold off on making decisions when you're overly enthusiastic about the anticipated result
- Spend more time analyzing the information
- Seek the opinions of experts

2. Don't act too slowly; instead:

- Face the realities of the situation
- Refuse to procrastinate
- Develop a sense of dissatisfaction with the status quo
- Don't involve any more people in the decision than necessary
- Act on the information you have at hand
- Realize you cannot accurately predict the future
  Recognize that from time-to-time you'll make mistakes

3. Don't be too autocratic; instead:

- Establish an environment that lets people feel comfortable about challenging you
- Avoid the omnipotence syndrome

Considerations In Judging Speeds Of Your Decisions

- What is the competition doing?
- What is the life-cycle of the decision?
- How reversible is the decision?
- How big is the downside?

I'm sure you've noticed that ironically, every barrier to good decision making is the mirror image of the characteristics of good decision making. The art of good decision making lies in the balance of these elements!

And again, I'm going to ask you to refer back to your five decisions in Section 1. Hopefully, you've listed some decisions that you consider to be failures. (If not, think of a unsuccessful decision or two you've made.) Run them against the five barriers to good decision making and see if you can determine what went wrong.

Use this space below for notes.

SESSION 6
Styles of Decision Making

Carl Jung came up with four basic decision-making styles that hold true to this day. In this audio program, I refer to them as: The Bull, Eagle, Bee, Bloodhound. They're very important to understand in developing Confident Decision Making, so you may want to listen to this session several times.

While you study this session, first it's important to recognize which style you are. Then you can adjust your style to the type of decision that needs to be made. Secondly, you'll be able to see how others make their decisions, which should promote better understanding and better working and personal relationships for you.

Table XIII — Four Styles of Decision Making

Input	Decision Process	
	Conscious	Unconscious
Knowing	Bull	Eagle
Observing	Bloodhound	Bee

Determining Styles
And How To Interact With Each

People make decisions in three stages:
- –take in information
- –process the information
- –decide

Looking at the chart, you can see that the top to bottom dimensions on the chart analyze how people take in information. The types at the top think they already know while the types at the bottom want to learn.

The left to right dimensions of the chart show how the types tend to process the information—conscious thought on the left, unconscious thought on the right.

Bulls consciously know. They attack a problem. When dealing with a Bull, be direct and straightforward.

Eagles unconsciously know. They leap at an opportunity. Convert their preconceptions with enthusiasm and flare.

Bees are unconsciously open. They build consensus. They're open-minded, yet skeptical. Build a relationship with them.

Bloodhounds are consciously open. They seek more information. They have the hardest time arriving at decisions. They're open-minded, don't have preconceived notions on which to make decisions, and seldom feel they have enough facts.

You'll have the most difficulty with the decision-making style in the corner opposite yours.

Bulls have trouble working with Bees. The Bull is ready to move while the Bee is still getting comfortable with the situation. The Bee doesn't understand how the Bull can be so callous and uncaring.

Eagles have trouble understanding the Bloodhound. The Eagle is excited and ready to go with the decision while the Bloodhound thinks much more research is needed. Bloodhounds find it hard to believe that the Eagle wants to go with the first decision that seems right.

Have you determined which style you are? Knowing your style can dramatically affect your work with Confident Decision Making processes. For instance, if you're an Eagle or a Bee, you love intuitive and creative thought. If you're a Bull or a Bloodhound, you love the logical approaches taught in this program. You expand your opportunities when you try the approach that isn't natural to you.

Write the names of two people with whom you work. Maybe choose one boss and one subordinate or peer. Then write down which style fits each. Think about that the next time you're in decision-making processes with each of them. You may want to try the same exercise with two personal friends.

NAME	TYPE/STYLE

Your next challenge is to expand your decision-making capabilities. You want to match your approach to the problem rather than match your approach to your decision-making style. Again, this is where the art of decision making comes into play.

SESSION 7
Characteristics of Great Decision Makers

In addition to logical and intuitive techniques to decision making, there are eight extra characteristics beyond these that make great decision makers.

Great Decision Makers:

- Have a high tolerance for ambiguity
- Have a well-ordered sense of priorities
  - –Seeing the big picture
  - –Acting without needing approval
  - –Thinking independently
  - –Strong inner values
- Can build consensus around a decision
- Avoid stereotypes
  - –Be aware this is the dark side of chunking
- Are resilient
  - –Understand your style and methods and vary them to produce more creative solutions
- Understand both hard and soft input
- Are realistic
  - –Avoid blind trust
- Avoid decision minefields
  - –The "If Donald Trump made an offer, it must be a bargain" syndrome
  - –If it's being advertised, it must be selling
  - –If the Japanese are doing it, it must be right
  - –The seller of the idea is enthusiastic
  - –Relying on expert advice

Self Test II

Here's the repeat of the self-test that we promised you at the start of this workbook.

Please take this test *after* you have listened to the CD program several times and have implemented the ideas it offers in your daily decision-making processes. This will show you the progress you've made.

Instructions: For each type of decision listed below, score yourself on a scale of one to ten, with ten being the highest, on how well you feel you are now doing—after putting new decision making ideas to work—in each of these areas of your life.

Name_____ Job/Title_____	
Business decision making	
Decisions involving how to spend money	
Decisions involving personal relationships	
Decisions about career moves	
Decisions involving your children	
Investment decisions	
Decisions involving your parents	
Total score	

Know Your Driving Life Force

Use this chart to rate yourself. Place a check in front of the number.

Question 1: Until you were 7 years old, how loved did you feel?

Rate yourself on a scale of 1 to 10. A high score of 10 means that no one could have been raised in a more loving environment, and a rating of 1 means that as a child you never felt loved.

Question 2: Until you were 7 years old, how secure did you feel?

Again, rate yourself on a scale of 1 to 10. A high score of 10 means you always felt perfectly safe and secure, and 1 means you never knew from one moment to the next what was going to happen to you.

On both questions, most people will be somewhere between 1 and 10. You may be below 5 on the love question but above 5 when it comes to security, or visa versa. Or you could have a low or high score in both areas.

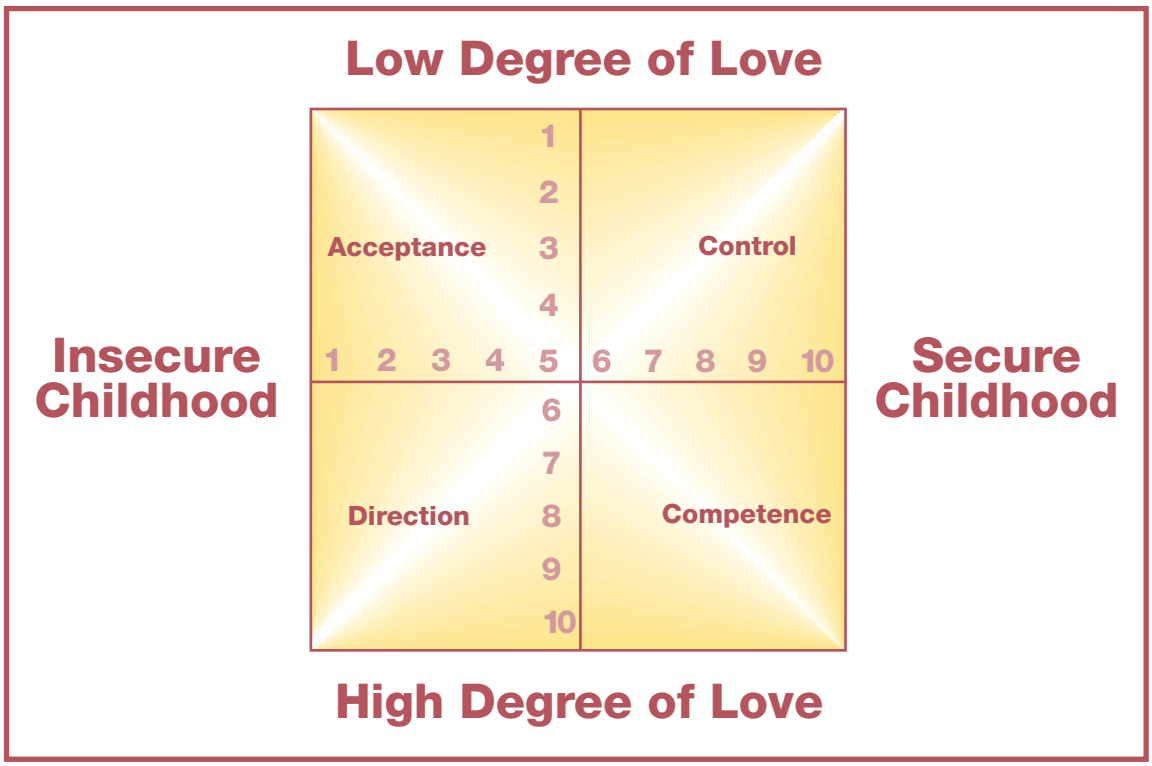
Combine your scores on both questions. You now have two scores, one for each question, such as 4-3 or 5-7. Translate your score into words. A 4-3 score would be low-low. A 4-7 would be low-high. An 8-2 score would be high-low. And a 7-6 would be high-high.

Mark your score on the chart. Low-low means that you're an Acceptance person. Low-high means that you're a Control person. High-low means that Direction is your driving force. And High-high means that you're a Competence person.

Someone with a dominant trait of either Acceptance or Direction is probably a person who had an insecure childhood. This causes them to spend their lives seeking acceptance of either themselves or their ideas. On the other hand people raised in a very secure environment can become either highly competent people or dominant leaders.

A person with the dominant traits of Acceptance or Control often need to feel accepted and to control their environment because they lack confidence in their self-worth and ability to handle the unexpected.

If your dominant traits are Direction or Competence, you tend to have both the self-esteem to work well with people and the confidence to be able to handle whatever problems come your way. You tend to be a high achiever.



Are You an Optimist or a Pessimist? Check your "P's" and "I's" to Find Out!

Use this chart to guide you.

You can't change what happens to you, but you can change your behavior directly following an event. That's because your behavior is dependent on three "P's" and three "I's" over which you have control.

The first "P" stands for Permanent, and the first "I" stands for its opposite, Impermanent. The optimist sees good things as permanent, or always happening again in similar patterns, whereas they see bad things as one-time flukes. The pessimist sees bad things as having permanence or always occurring in repeating fashion. However, good things are viewed as only temporary or non-recurrent.

The second "P" stands for Personal and the second "I" stands for Impersonal. Optimists tend to view good events as being brought about by their own merit or effort, while bad events are someone else's fault. However, pessimists take credit for bad circumstances and give other factors credit for the good events that happen.

The third "P" stands for Pervasive and the third "I" stands for Isolated. The optimist sees good events as happening all around, that the world is basically a positive place. The optimist views bad events as isolated occurrences. The pessimist on the other hand views the world as a basically dangerous place where bad things are always happening. Good events to pessimists are isolated occurrences.

You can train yourself to be more optimistic by changing the way you interpret events. Use the chart to check your interpretations of the things that happen to you. When you find your interpretation in the bottom half, ask yourself if there is a more positive way to look at the event.

	GOOD EVENTS	BAD EVENTS
	Permanent	Impermanent
OPTIMISTIC THINKING	Personal	Impersonal
	Pervasive	Isolated
	Impermanent	Permanent
PESSIMISTIC THINKING	Impersonal	Personal
	Isolated	Pervasive

Use this page for any additional notes or thoughts you want to record.

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